

GATE 1

PRACTICAL ASSESSMENT

TOTAL MARKS	100	CA WEIGHT	7.5%
FOCUS	Vulnerability • Prioritisation • Remediation	LEVEL	Beginner

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Date: _October 10th 2026_____ Score: _____ / 100

YOUR TASK

Analyse the evidence, decide what should be fixed first, then plan and verify the remediation.

Use only the information provided. Do not use CVSS alone. Consider severity, asset importance, exposure and exploitation evidence.

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CASE STUDY

A training centre has completed an authorised vulnerability assessment of four systems. You are the junior cybersecurity analyst reviewing the evidence.

Asset	System	Purpose	Importance
A01	Windows Staff PC	Staff office activities	Medium
A02	Linux Web Server	Hosts the organisation's website	High
A03	Student Lab PC	Cybersecurity practicals	Low
A04	File Server	Stores important organisational files	High

Finding	Asset	Security Finding	CVSS	Exposure	Exploitation
F01	A02	Outdated web-server software with a known security vulnerability	9.1	Network accessible	Reported
F02	A01	Important security update is missing	7.5	Internal only	None known
F03	A03	Weak local password policy	5.3	Local access required	None known
F04	A04	Unnecessary network service is enabled	8.2	Internal network	None known

QUESTION 1 ANALYSE THE FINDINGS [30 MARKS]

Review the four findings and complete the worksheet below.

Finding	What is the security weakness?	What makes it a concern?
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F01	The Linux server is Running outdated software with a known vulnerability.	The the server is network-accessible exploitation has been reported and it hosts the organisation important website and this combination creates an urgent risk.
F02	An important security update is missing from the Windows staff PC	Unpatched software may remain vulnerable to known attacks and the PC is internal only and no exploitation is known, which lowers its urgency compared with F01 and F04.
F03	The student lab PC has a weak local password policy.	Weak passwords can be easier to guess or crack and however this is a lower-importance asset, local access is required, CVSS is 5.3 and no exploitation is known.
F04	The file server has an unnecessary network service enabled.	The service increases the attack surface and the server stores important organisational files and has CVSS 8.2 and although exposure is limited to the internal network and no exploitation is known the potential impact makes this a high priority.

7.5 marks per finding.

QUESTION 2 PRIORITISE THE FINDINGS [35 MARKS]

Rank the findings from the one that should be addressed first to the one that can wait the longest.

Priority	Finding	Reason for your decision
1 — Highest	F01	CVSS 9.1, network-accessible, and exploitation has been reported and It affects the high importance web server, so it presents the most immediate risk.

2	F04	The file server stores important organisational files and CVSS is 8.2 also unnecessary network service increases the attack surface, even though access is internal and exploitation is not known.
3	F02	The missing update has CVSS 7.5, but the PC is internal only and no exploitation is known. should still be patched promptly.
4 — Lowest	F03	CVSS 5.3, low importance lab asset, local access required, and no known exploitation. Improve the password policy, but it is the least urgent of these four based on the supplied evidence.

Consider CVSS, asset importance, exposure and exploitation evidence. Do not rank by CVSS alone.

Why is your #1 finding the highest priority?

_F01 is the highest priority because it has a high CVSS score of 9.1, is accessible over the network, and exploitation has been reported. It also affects the high-importance web server that hosts the organisation's website and the combination of severity, exposure, asset importance and evidence of exploitation makes it the most urgent finding to remediate.

QUESTION 3 REMEDIATE AND VERIFY [35 MARKS]

Choose the TWO findings you ranked highest. Prepare a practical remediation plan for both.

	Finding 1	Finding 2
Finding ID	VULN-01	VULN-02
Problem	Outdated Software	Weak administrative credentials
Recommended fix	Install the latest software updates and security patches.	Enforce a strong password policy and change default login details
Owner / responsible team	IT infrastructure Team	Identity and access management
Expected result	The system software is updated and secure against known flaws.	Unauthorized users cannot guess passwords or use default logins.

16 marks — 8 marks per finding.

RETEST EVIDENCE

BEFORE REMEDIATION	AFTER REMEDIATION
Affected software: Outdated Vulnerability detected: Yes Status: Vulnerable	Software updated Vulnerability check performed again Vulnerability detected: No Status: No longer vulnerable

Answer these three points:

1. What does the before evidence show? It shows targets system was running outdated software with an active security flaw, meaning the asset was officially at risk and flagged as vulnerable
2. What does the after evidence show? It shows that the system was successfully updated and a new security check was run and no further vulnerability were detected
3. Can the finding be marked as resolved? Why? Yes and why is because the software patched successfully fixed the issues and the follow up scan confirmed the risk is gone and the system status is now no longer vulnerable.

19 marks — retest and verification.

REVIEW	ASSIGN	PLAN	APPLY	RETEST	RECORD
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MARK SUMMARY

Question	Practical Skill	Marks
1	Analyse vulnerability evidence	30
2	Prioritise and justify	35
3	Remediate, retest and verify	35
TOTAL		100

Gate 1 contribution: 7.5% of the overall Continuous Assessment.

Score conversion: Gate 1 score ÷ 100 × 7.5